

project.org

LIBRARY ACTIVITY CARD

Harlem Renaissance Library

Grades 1–2 · Go Deeper

RED LEVEL
GO DEEPER

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

The Harlem Renaissance was a time of **cultural explosion** — when artists, musicians, and writers found each other in Harlem and created work that would change America. Aaron Douglas chose silhouettes so his figures could represent everyone, not just one person.

01

PART 1

Compare two works

LOOK FOR IT ON THE LIBRARY DISPLAY
Aaron Douglas — *Song of the Towers*, 1934

LOOK FOR IT ON THE LIBRARY DISPLAY
Aaron Douglas — *The Creation*, c.1935

1. Both use silhouettes and circles. What is different about the mood of each painting? Why?

02

PART 2

Write and think

2. Langston Hughes wrote: *"I, too, sing America."* In your own words, what do you think he meant? How does that connect to Aaron Douglas's paintings?

3. If you could add one thing to the Harlem Renaissance — a painting, a poem, a song, a story — what would it be, and why?

MINI MUSEUM Visit: **minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance**